VICTORY 2027

The First War Of Independence

LECTURE-2 History

Kunal Sir



Topics To Be Covered

1. Quick Recap
2. Socio-Religious Causes
3. Economic and Military Causes
4. Questions

Swagat Hai Cheems and T-Rex Gang Ka



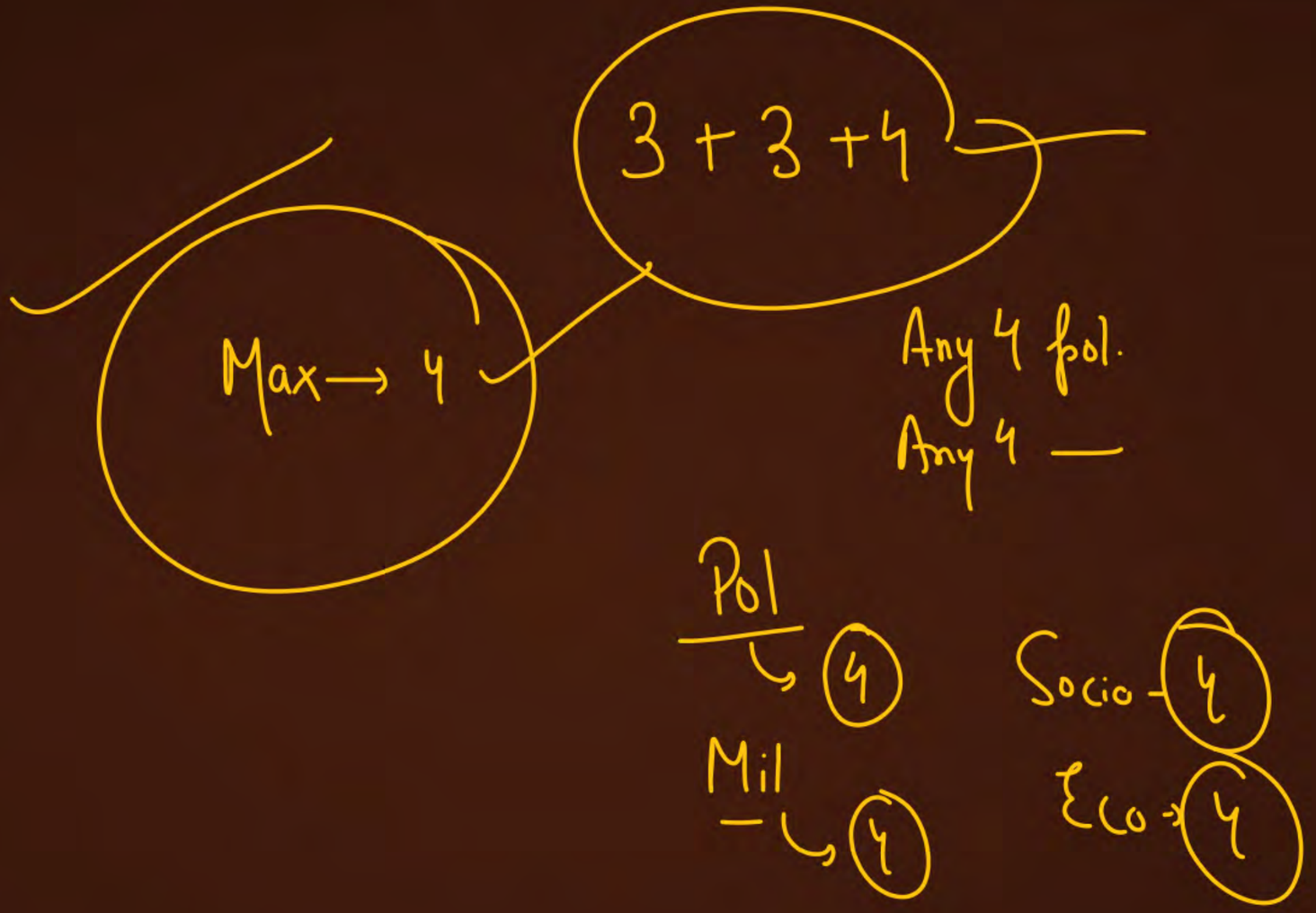


Kya Hua Vro ? Mujhe Dekh Ke History Yad A Gayi ?





Hemlo Domsto !
Mai Apka Class Monitor Douglas


3 + 3 + 4
Max → 4
Any 4 pol.
Any 4 —
Pol
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Mil
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Socio
4
Eco
4

1. The Indian National Movement (1857 - 1917)

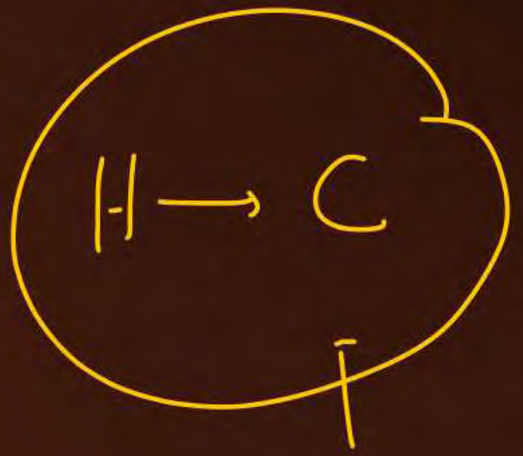
(a) The First War of Independence, 1857

Only the causes (political, socio-religious, economic and military) and consequences – (Only changes in the administration, Queen Victoria's Proclamation, Relation with Princely states and Changes in the Army) will be tested. [The events, however, need to be mentioned in order to maintain continuity and for a more comprehensive understanding.]



QUESTIONS

Religious Disability act of 1850 describes as-



A Change in the religion will lead to loss in property.

B No conversion of religion

C Conversion from Hindu to Christianity, no loss of property.

D None of the above

QUESTIONS

Nana Saheb was the adopted son of

A Ruler of Jhansi

B Ruler of Mysore

C Siraj-ud-daulah

D Baji Rao II

QUESTIONS

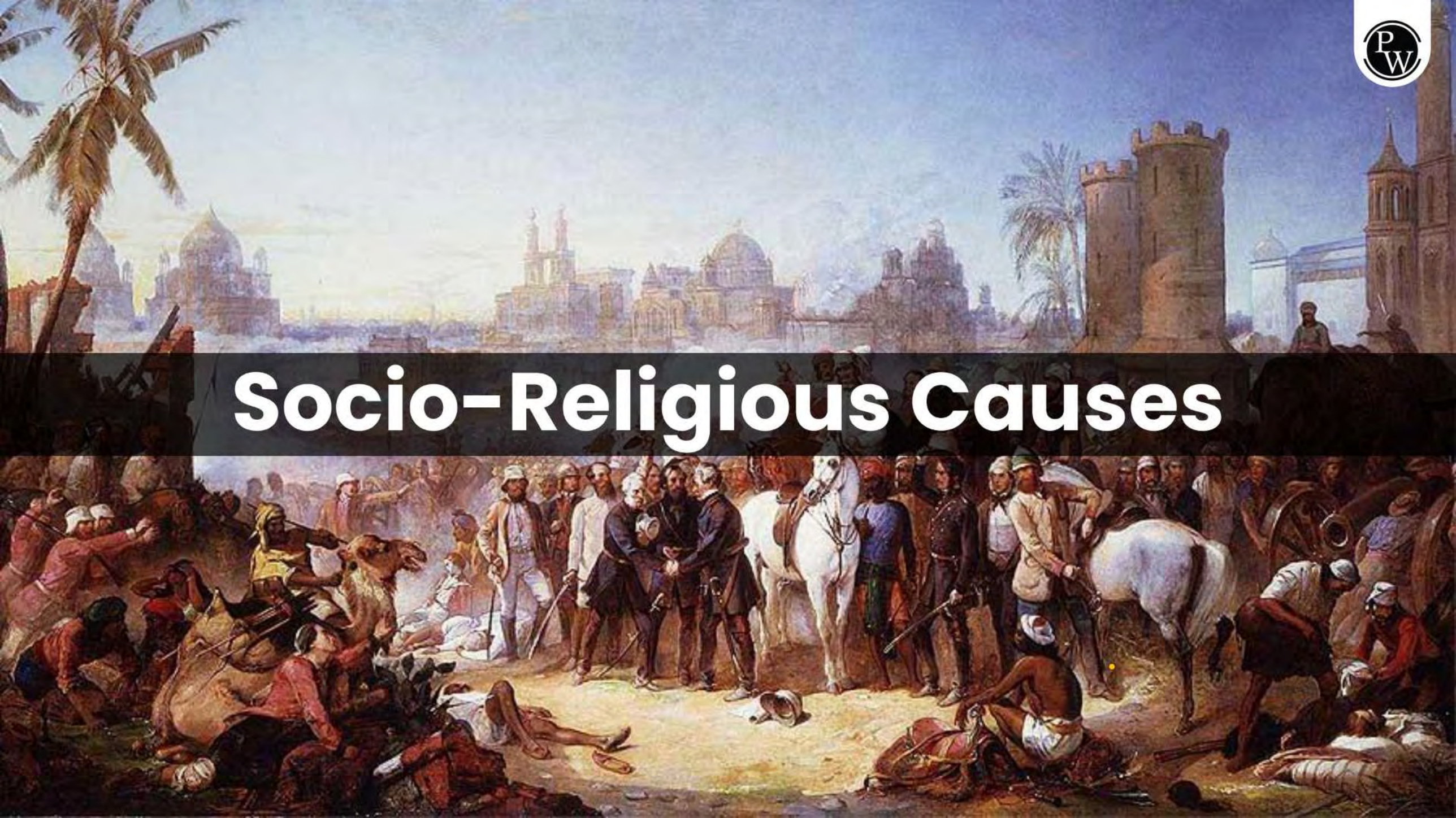
What do you mean by Absentee Sovereignty of the British?

(A) Indian rulers lost their sovereignty.

(B) India was governed by British government, a distance of thousand miles.

(C) Company had the full power to rule India.

(D) All of the above



Socio-Religious Causes

Policy Of Racial Discrimination

- The British racially discriminated against the Indians
- The British believed that they were superior to the Indians and followed a policy of contempt towards the Indians.
- Indians were ill-treated and insulted.
- They considered muslims as cruel and unfaithful



Laws Of Property

Laws of Property:

- The Religious Disabilities Act 1850 changed the Hindu Law of property.
- According to this an Indian who had converted to Christianity could inherit the property of his ancestors.
- Indians regarded this as a trick by the British to convert people into Christianity.



Indians To British

Oppression Of The Poor

- Complex judicial system enabled the rich to oppress the cultivators.
- They were flogging, tortured and imprisoned if they could not pay arrears of rent, land revenue and interest on debt.
- Police and petty officials were corrupt- rich got away but poor tortured.



Activities Of The Missionaries

- During 18th century, British showed a friendly attitude towards Indian religions- Trustee of some Hindu temples.
- But in 19th century, this friendly attitude was changed.
- They began to interfere in local religious and social customs- denounced idol worship and called local beliefs as ignorance.



Christianity
Roman Catholics
Protestant

Activities Of The Missionaries

- After 1813, The activities of the missionaries increased .
- The Indians believed that the government was supporting missionary activities and wanted to convert them to Christianity.

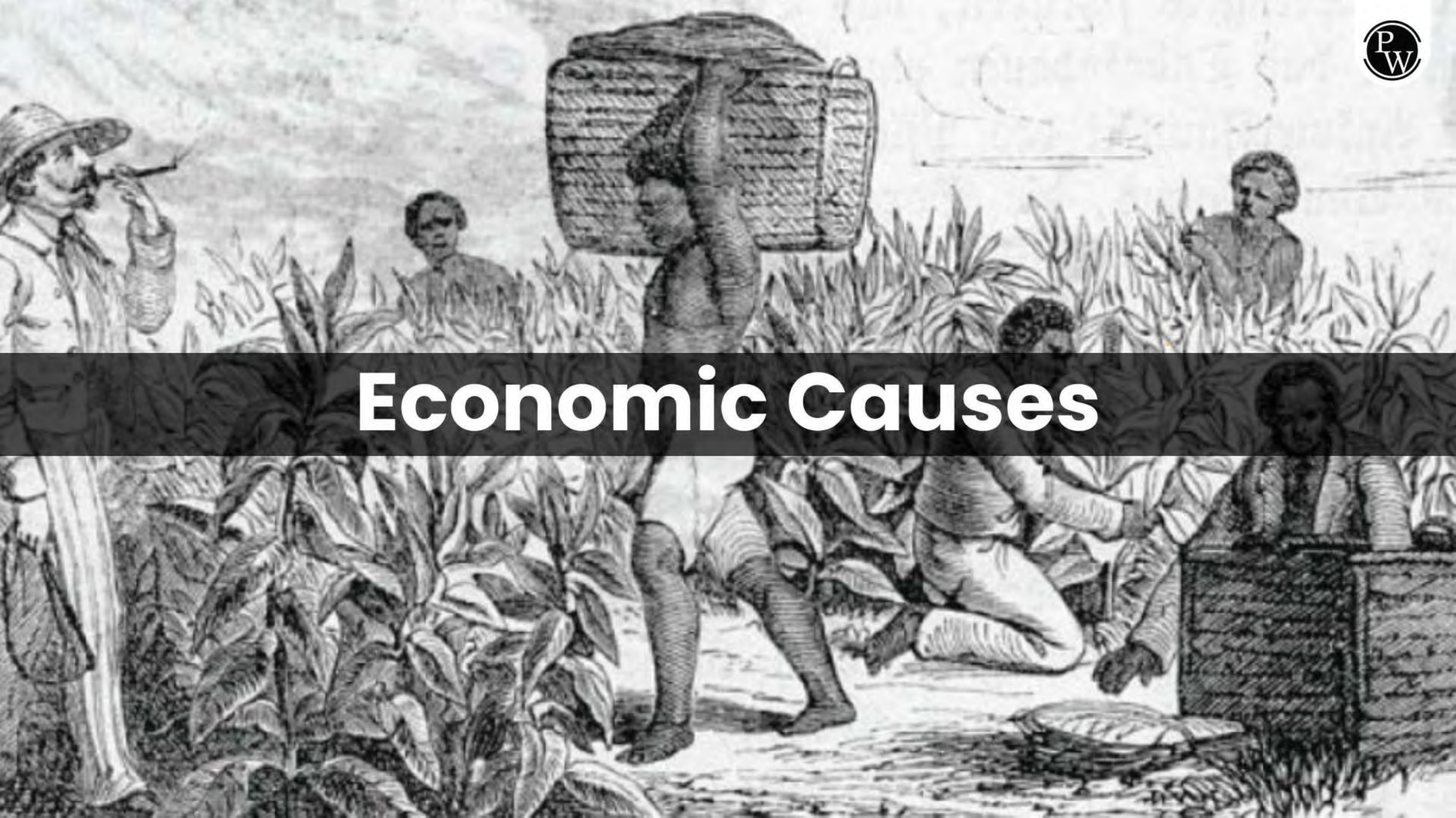


Taxing Religious Institutions

Taxing Religious Institutions:

- The British began to tax lands belonging to temples and mosques. This hurt the religious sentiments .

- The families dependent on these lands began to say that the British were trying to weaken religions in India.



Economic Causes

Economic Causes

Exploitation of Economic Resources

- British overexploited the resources of the country.
- India was forced to export raw materials to Britain at very low rates
- Plantation products and food grains were exported to Britain.
- No import duties –ready made British goods , high import duties – Indian goods exported to Britain .
- Result –Decline in Indian industries

Drain of Wealth

- British –after establishing rule in Bengal, purchased raw materials to be exported to Britain using Indian revenues
- Salaries and pensions of British officers –paid from Indian revenues Result – Drain of wealth from India

Decay of Cottage and Handicraft

- Free trade policy destroyed Indian industries
- Indian goods not able to compete cheap British machine -made goods
- High taxes imposed on Indian goods entering Britain
- Result – Loss of livelihood

Economic Causes

Exploitation of Indian Peasants

- British imposed heavy taxes on peasants
- Ex: Revenue increased in Bengal
- Farmers had to sell land – as not able to pay increased revenues
- Traders and Moneylenders – became owners of land –did nothing to improve land –only concerned with collecting revenues

Result-poor condition of peasants

Poverty and Famine

- Economic policies of British made Indians poor
- Famines became common
- British did nothing to minimize the impact of famines

Decline Of Landed Aristocracy

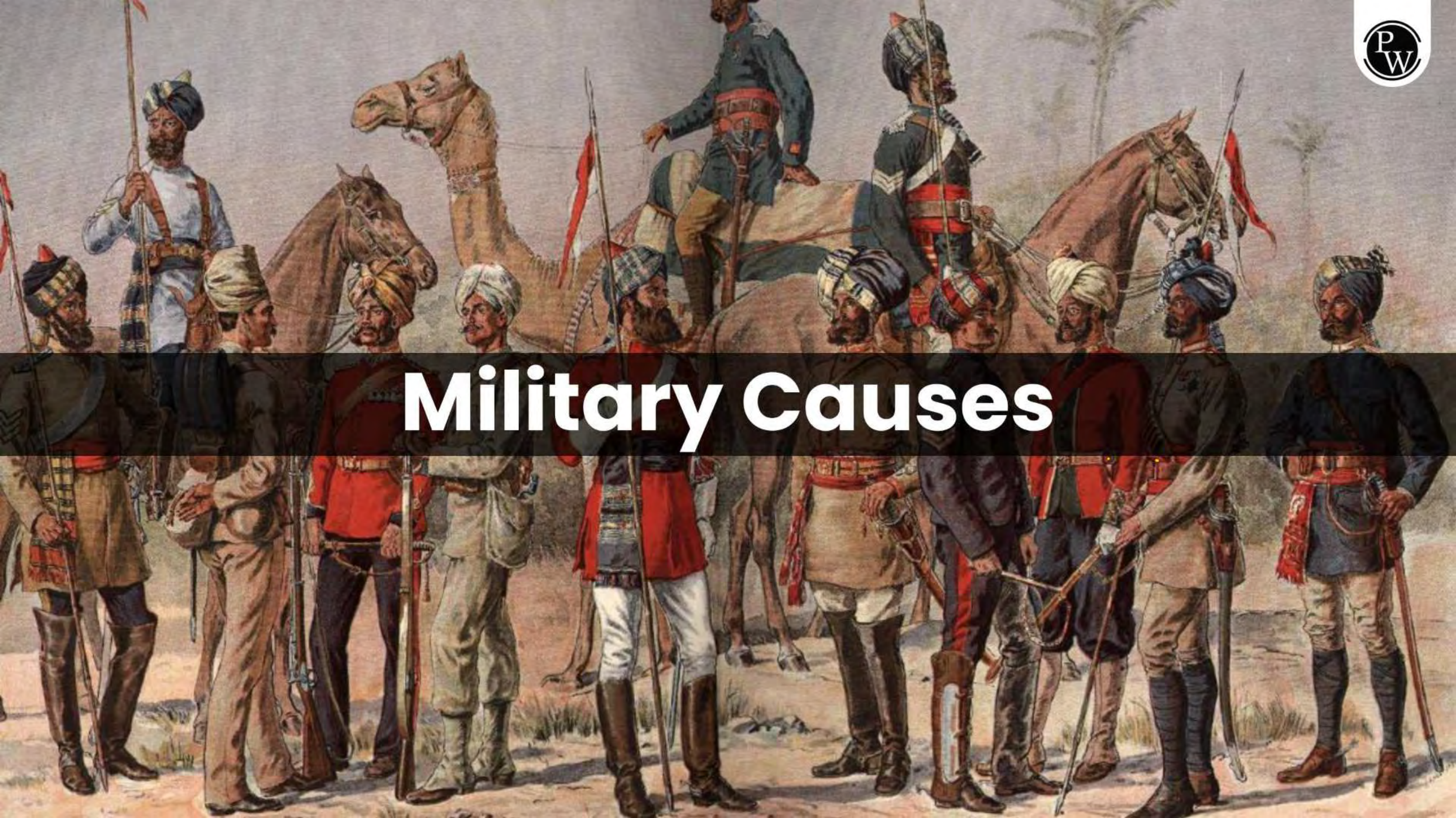
- Zamindars and Taluqdars deprived of their land
- Inam Commission passed in 1852, about 20,000 estates were confiscated and were given to the highest bidder.
- Awadh –landed aristocracy lost rights over land



Ques.

According to Inam Commission _____ estates were confiscated.

(a) 15,000
(b) 30,000
(c) 20,000
(d) 65,000



Military Causes

Military Causes

Ill treatment of Indian Soldiers

- Indian soldiers not treated well
- Insulted by British officers
- Indians –could never rise above the rank of Subedar

General Service Enlistment Act

- 1856-law passed that a sepoy had to travel overseas whenever required by the Company.
- Hindus believed - one could lose his caste status and religion if he crosses the seas.
- The sepoys thought the Company was trying to defame their religion.

Large No.of Indians In British army

- British army –consisted more of Indian soldiers
- It became easy for Indians to take up arms against the British

Military Causes

Deprivation of Allowances

- Post Office Act of 1854 withdrew the privilege of free postage enjoyed by the sepoys.
- Sepoys were also required to serve in areas located away from their homes without extra payment and additional Bhatta (foreign service allowance).

Low Salaries

- The wages and salaries of the Indian soldiers were too low to support their families.
- The British soldiers received higher salaries.

8 times more Indians

Poor Performance Of The British Troops

- In first Afghan war [1838–42], Punjab wars [1845–49] and in Crimean war [1853–56]
- In (1855-56) Santhal Tribesmen of Bihar and Bengal temporarily swept the British from their area.
- Myth was broken that British were invincible.
- Indian soldiers understood – British Army could be defeated by dedicated Indian Army

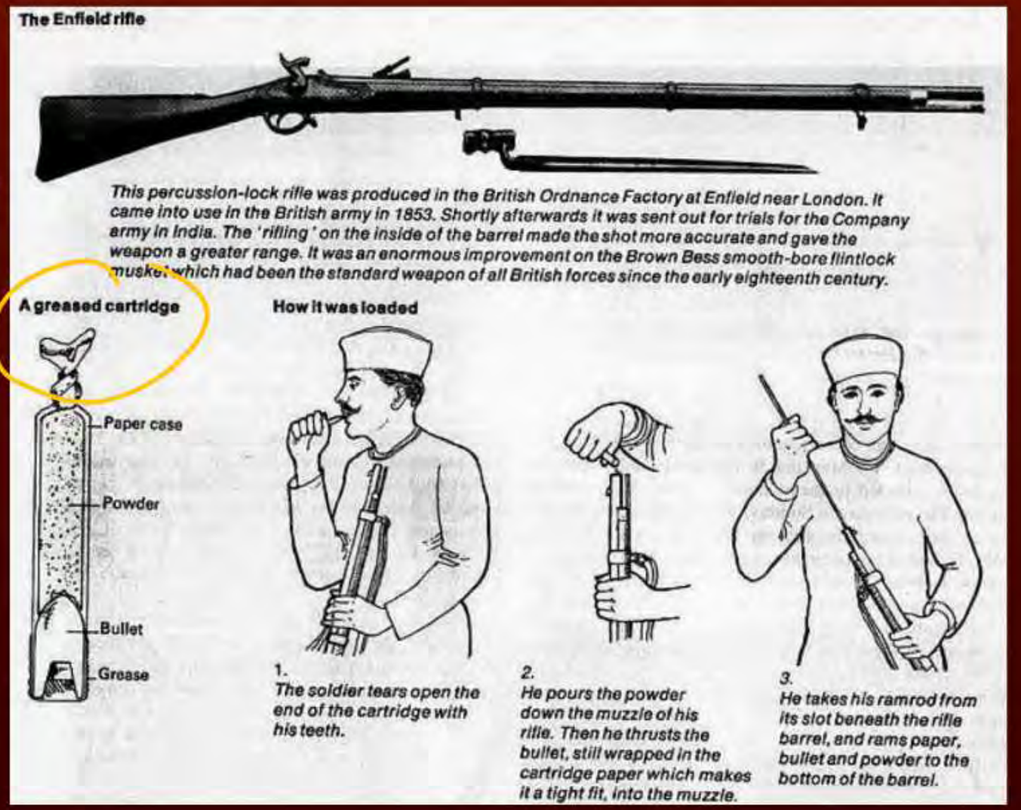


Immediate Cause

The British had introduced a new ‘Enfield Rifle’ in the army replacing old fashioned musket rifle(called brown bess)

This rifle needed a cartridge which had a greased paper cover.

This paper cover had to be bitten off before loading the cartridge into the rifle. Rumours spread that the greased paper was made of beef and pork.



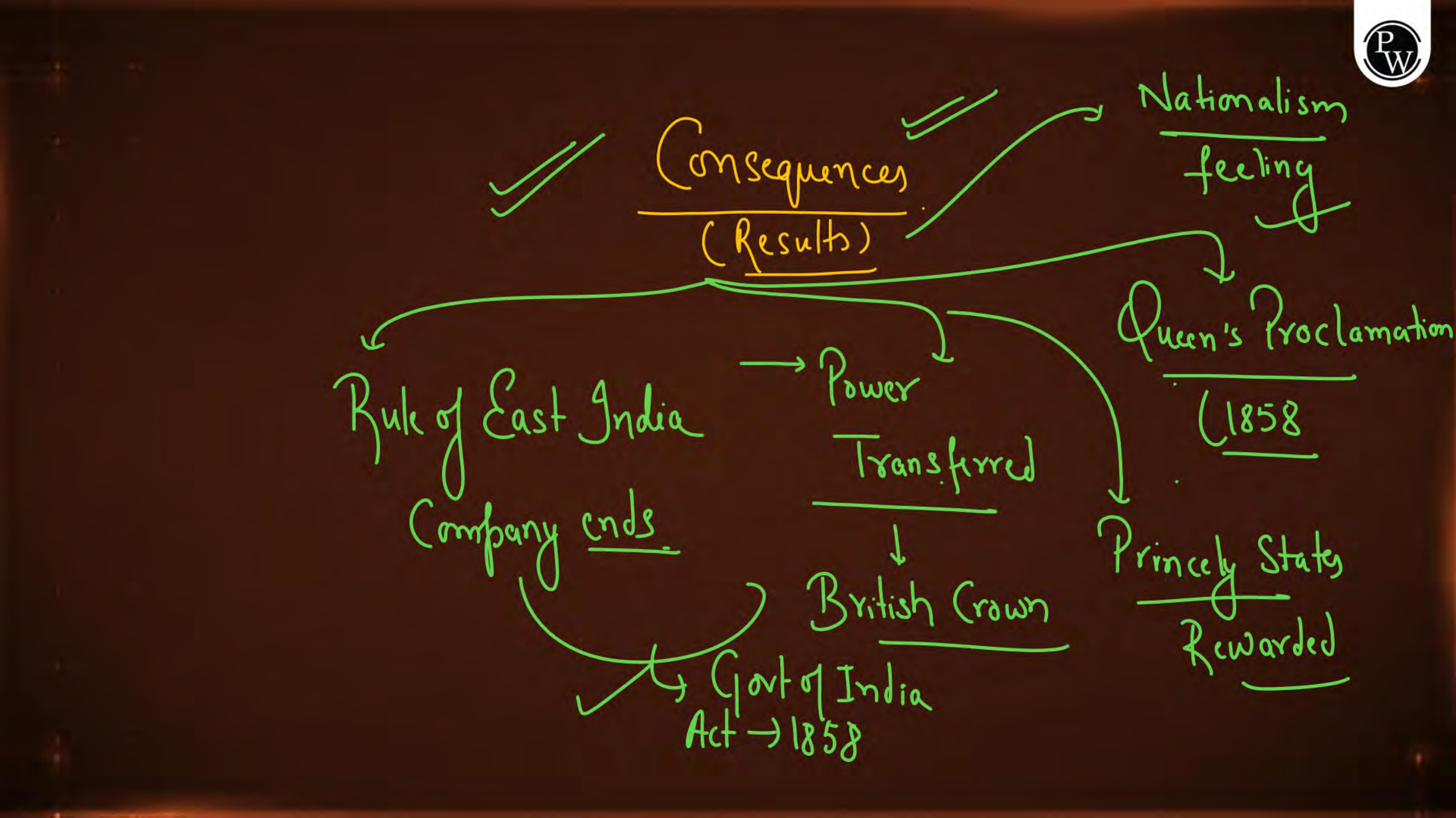
Soldiers felt that it was a move by the British to defame their religion. Mangal Pandey urged his fellow soldiers not to use the rifle.

Beginning Of Uprising

- 26th February 1857- Native Infantry at Berhampur [Bengal] refused to accept the cartridges given to them.
- Regiment was disbanded- warning to other regiments.
- Mangal Pandey attacked on the Adjutant of 34th native infantry at Barrackpore on 29 March 1857.
- He was executed after a court-martial.






Consequences
(Results)
Nationalism
feeling
Queen's Proclamation
1858
Rule of East India
Company ends
Power
Transferred
British Crown
Princely States
Rewarded
Govt of India
Act → 1858

Ques

First War of Independence according to British Historians was _____.

(a) Religious uprising
(b) Well-organised war
(c) Civil Rights Movement
(d) Military Mutiny

HOMEWORK

- Revise
- Solve DPP

Tomorrow's Class

- Consequences of Revolt
- Questions

Sepoy mutiny

Soldier → Small protest fight

Thank You